

going into the imperial palace to hold offices in the late Kangxi Reign, the technique of enamel-painting was also brought in. Combined with Chinese traditional techniques of the wire inlaid enamel and of the glassware, the painters in the palace succeeded in making the enamel coloured porcelain after the 50th year of Kangxi Reign. At the initial time of making, the porcelain bodies were made by the Imperial Factory in Jingdezhen, and were painted by the enamel painters in the palace with imported colour pigments. Most of the modelling types were such small-sided utensils as bowl, plate, and dish. The decoration included abstract patterns (line drawing bearing the symbolising meanings) and the flower sprays pattern painted on the outside of unglazed bodies, then filled with red, yellow and purple colour pigments as the ground, being simple and vigorous in pigments, fresh and beautiful in colour. The colourful flower petals in the bowl decorated with peony pattern were harmonious, pure and natural in colours from the petal stem to the petal edge, with colours thickly filled, corollas bending and green leaves supported, full of vigour and glittering colour.

Fencai came after the enamel when the craftsmen in the Imperial Factory applied the rouge red decoration in the enamel into the five-colours decoration to distinguish the grades of depth, lightness, brightness and darkness of blossoms, producing the feeling of mildness and softness, which was the source of *Fencai*. Afterwards, the enamel-painting technique was gradually applied to the five-colours and developed a special style of *Fencai*.

The porcelains made in Kangxi Reign were rich in modelling, covering the display porcelain such as vase, *Zun*, flower *Gu* (long-belly vase), and flower basin; the daily use porcelain such as bowl, plate, cup, dish, jar, and *Gang*; the stationary porcelain such as brush pot, brush rack, water *Yu*, case for placing seal; the sacrificial and religious porcelain such as *Jue*, bean (*Dou*, stem cup), vase; and other porcelain including various kinds of carved porcelains, garden stools and porcelains for export.

The new models included the club-shaped vase, the oil-mallet-shaped vase, the plate in shape of chrysanthemum petals, the Guanyin (or Avalokitesvara) *Zun*, the peacock-tail *Zun*, the Taibai *Zun*, etc., each characterised by distinctive feature of its own and representing the typical style of the time, with vigorous, graceful and dignified shapes. The utensils made by the civil kilns were much larger; most outlines of which were straight lines as a whole and were co-ordinated by curves, forming a straight and robust style. For example, the club-shaped vase was a large square object with everted mouth, short neck, flattened and

downward-bending shoulder, long belly, wide upper part and narrow lower part on each side, and the turning was distinctive in such parts as mouth, neck, shoulder and belly, full of robust and straight force, representing the typical character of modelling in Kangxi Reign.

The themes or subjects of Kangxi porcelain were extensive, with that "pattern must hold some meaning, and the meaning must bear auspiciousness." The majority of products by the Imperial Factory were decorated with dragon-and-phoenix, cloud-and-dragon, sea water and sea dragon, cloud-and-phoenix, phoenix-in-flowers, "*All Birds Pay Court to the Phoenix*," peony, peacock-and-turtledove, green bird and lotus pond, seasons' scenery, fishermen, woodsman farmer and scholar and so on. The materials were drawn from the figure pictures in *The Romance of the Three Kingdoms* (《三國演義》), *All Men Were Brothers* (《水滸》), *The Western Chamber* (《西廂記》) and such novels, plays and legendary stories, with most of them being the "knights" in a suit of armour, with sword and fluttering banners, displaying a majestic-looking and magnificent scene, brimful of vigorous life. Besides, some were decorated with famous Chinese calligraphic works like *Preface to the Orchid Pavilion Collection* (《蘭亭集序》), the first place of Chinese calligraphic work by Wang Xizhi, also having a unique style.

At this time, the layout of pictures was full, with a large area arranged for thematic patterns, and some vases and plates even having no edge decoration, so as to enhance the overspreading momentum of the patterns. The plumpy peony blossom, the peaks rising one higher than another, the erect buns and well-full faces of portrayed ladies all providing a lofty sense of straight and impressive looking and a beauty of positiveness and fortitude.

In brief, the modelling, theme or motif, and decoration were all integrated with and unified in one mood, formed a typical style of the time -- **the beauty of vigorousness and firmness.**

YONGZHENG REIGN The new prospect created in Kangxi Reign saw, in this period, a further development in the modelling and decoration of porcelains, making the flowers of porcelains vying with each other for beauty.

FENCAI AND ENAMEL After the 6th year of Yongzheng Reign, the enamel pigment was extracted after experiments by the Workshop Within the Palace, thus the making of coloured enamel porcelains entered its heyday. With abundant and beautiful colours and diverse varieties, most products were with sketched